

“
We live not according to reason, but
according to fashion.
”

SENECA, ROMAN PHILOSOPHER, 1ST CENTURY CE

3,500–3,000BCE	3,000–2,000BCE	2,000–1,000BCE	1,000–500BCE	500BCE–0	0–600CE
c. 3,300BCE Clothing, previously fastened with straight pins of wood, is now secured with <i>fibula</i> (metal brooches) or pins.	 ◀ Egyptian necklaces				
	c. 2,500BCE Egyptian men and women wear distinctive eye make-up, made from kohl, and large black wigs of real human and horse hair. Kohl has been popular in Egypt since 3,000BCE.	c. 1,900BCE Jewellery starts to play an important role in Egypt with gold being prized above other metals. Coloured glass and semi precious gems, including red jasper, carnelian, and garnets are also used. Necklaces are worn in daily life and also buried with the dead.		490–460BCE This bronze mirror is set atop a sculpture of Aphrodite, who wears a peplos and is flanked by cupids.	
c. 3,500BCE The Chinese learn to manufacture silk from silkworms, and use it to fashion sophisticated luxury textiles.	c. 2,500BCE To accompany high-status individuals into the afterlife, jewellery such as a flexible torc (neck ring) made from thin discs of gold are buried along with the deceased.		▲ Red figure vase c. 600–500BCE c. 600BCE Red-figure vases show figures of Ancient Greece wearing large pieces of fabric, draped to achieve the distinctive Grecian style.	c. 300BCE Not only is armour designed to protect the wearer, it also denotes social status and identity. The first mail armour formed of links is developed in the 3rd century BCE.	476CE The Fall of Rome – Constantinople (modern-day Istanbul) is the centre of the Byzantine world and a melting pot of Greek, Roman, Middle Eastern, and Oriental fashion styles.
	c. 2,000BCE Some silk is traded with Asia, but most Egyptians wear simple linen garments. Class is distinguished by the quality of linen and degree of embellishment.	▲ Minoan goddess c. 1700–1400	c. 500BCE The Classical period of Ancient Greece; women wear the peplos – a tunic gathered at the waist and fastened at the shoulders.		
	◀ Queen Nefertari	c. 1,700BCE Fashion flourishes on the prosperous island of Crete. The Minoans favour distinctive body-hugging garments, and are able to weave elaborate patterned wool cloths.	c. 509BCE The Roman Republic is founded. The distinctive Roman toga is worn by men and women in Rome; after the second century BCE, it is worn exclusively by men.		c. 500–548CE Byzantine emperors set trends with lavish clothing embroidered with jewels and stitched with gold.